



Course Outline

1. Course Identity

The information in this block should be exactly as approved by CUHK Senate. In case there are any differences, please explain in the table below.

Course code	GFH1000
Course title (English)	In Dialogue with Humanity
Course title (Chinese)	与人文对话
Units	3
Language of Instruction	English & Putonghua
Description (English)	This course aims to introduce students to classic texts concerning humanity and, more importantly, to inspire intellectual reflection on one's own life experience. Chosen texts include Plato's Symposium, the Analects, Zhuangzi, the Heart of Understanding, the Bible, the Qur'an, Waiting for the Dawn, the Social Contract, the Wealth of Nations, Economic and the Philosophic Manuscripts of 1844 and two other texts. Each week students will meet two times, one lecture and one interactive seminar. Emphasis will be placed on students' capacity to respond critically to the selected texts in oral and written presentations, in the form of class discussions, short write-ups, and term papers.
Description (Chinese)	本课程旨在介绍人文领域的经典篇目，鼓励学生结合自身生活经验进行反思。所选篇目包括《会饮篇》、《论语》、《庄子》、《般若之心》、《圣经》、《古兰经》、《明夷待访录》、《社会契约论》、《国富论》、《1844年经济学哲学手稿》等。每周设置一节大课和一节研讨课。课程的重点在于学生对所选篇目以口头和书面形式提出自己的批判性思考，具体形式包括课堂讨论、反思日志、期末论文等。

2. Prerequisites / Co-requisites

A. Prerequisites

Nil.

B. Co-requisites



Nil.

3. Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- articulate effectively views about the good life and the good society in class and in academic essays;
- have an enhanced confidence in reading and discussing complicated texts from the humanities;
- evaluate the soundness of different approaches to the good life and the good society from multiple perspectives;
- discuss the relevance of arguments and views expressed in the selected texts to contemporary human conditions; and
- have enriched personal views about the good life and the good society.

4. Course syllabus

Symposium, Analects, Zhuangzi, the Heart of Understanding, the Bible, the Qur'an, Waiting for the Dawn, the Social Contract, the Wealth of Nations, Economic and the Philosophic Manuscripts of 1844 and two other texts chosen by the instructor.

5. Assessment Scheme

Component/ method	% weight
Presentation and Participation	20
Quizzes	26
Reflective Journals	24
Term Paper	30

6. Grade descriptor

General

Grade	Description
A	Outstanding performance on all learning outcomes. Demonstrates the ability to critically review an issue in question. Has the ability to develop an argument in



	depth.
A-	Generally outstanding performance on all (or almost all) learning outcomes. Demonstrates the ability to state and apply principles of the course in a manner that is logical and comprehensive. Has the ability to develop an independent opinion based on the analysis of classic texts.
B	Substantial performance on all learning outcomes, OR high performance on some learning outcomes which compensates for less satisfactory performance on others, resulting in overall substantial performance.
C	Satisfactory performance on the majority of learning outcomes, possibly with a few weaknesses.
D	Barely satisfactory performance on a number of learning outcomes
F	Unsatisfactory performance on a number of learning outcomes, OR failure to meet specified assessment requirements.

7. Feedback for evaluation

Online Course and Teaching Evaluation (OCTE)

8. Reading

Required Reading

1. In Dialogue with Humanity (与人文对话), 978-988-16660-4-8, Hong Kong: Office of University General Education, CUHK, 3RD ED. OR 4TH ED., China

9. Course components

Activity	Hours/week
Lectures	2
Tutorials	4

10. Indicative teaching plan

Week	Content/ topic/ activity
01	Introduction
02	Symposium
03	Analects



04	Heart Sutra
05	Qur'an
06	Social Contract
07	Economic and Philosophic Manuscripts
01-	Odyssey or another text chosen by the instructor
02-	Ethics or another text chosen by the instructor
03-	Zhuangzi
04-	Bible
05-	Waiting for the Dawn
06-	Wealth of Nations
07-	Conclusions

11. **Any other information**

Attention is drawn to University policy and regulations on honesty in academic work, and to the disciplinary guidelines and procedures applicable to breaches of such policy and regulations. Details may be found at <http://www.cuhk.edu.cn/departsite/ar/en/Academic.html>.

With each assignment, students will be required to submit a signed declaration that they are aware of these policies, regulations, guidelines and procedures. For group projects, all students of the same group should be asked to sign on the declaration.

Only the final version of the assignment should be submitted via VeriGuide.

12. **Version date**

Version number	3
As of (date)	2024/04/22